Carolina Pulmonary & Sleep Clinic PLLC
570 New Waverly Place, Suite 140
Cary, NC 27518
Tel (919) 439 8580, Fax (919) 463 5600
www.carypulmonary.com

Insomnia Behavioral Modifications

A) Prior to Sleep Onset (going to bed)

(1) 3hrs before going to bed → **Do not go to bed with problems in mind**

Solution: Write down the problems you have to find the solutions
Train the brain

(2) 2hr before going to bed → **Do not think "sleeping" as a job / or work**

Solution: Make sleep fun. Relax and rest for a while before going to bed. Sleep is not a switch to turn it in or off.
Turn down the light
Take a hot bath / shower (rapid temperature decline is a "physiological sleeping pill")
Listen to music
Read a book
Paradoxical relaxation (feel the muscles – tighten and relax)
Yoga
Pre dream!! - think what you like to dream

(3) 1hr before going to bed → **Minimize light load (do not watch TV, go online or work the phones / TXT etc)**

This will lead to: Increase light load and dopamine rush, which will prevent proper sleep onset by disrupting circadian rhythm and melatonin secretion.

Solution: Switch off electronics 1 hr before going to bed
Reduce Light load (TV, Computer) or use blue light blocking eyewear

(4) 30min before going to bed → **If not feeling sleepy, do not go to bed and try to Sleep.**

Do not stay in bed thinking, tossing and turning, watching the ceiling.
Solution: **Go to bed only if sleepy**.

B) During sleep

If you cannot fall asleep within 30minutes, get out of the bedroom. Read a book, meditate or take a walk until you feel sleepy.
Stop clock watching

C) During wake

(1) **Wake up at the same time every day**
Go outside ,Open the blinds (do not use sunglasses which block the blue light). This will reset the circadian sleep clock.

(2) **Do not take naps**
Taking naps will lead to disruption of the homeostatic sleep drive.
Solution: Do not take naps during the day.

(3) **Avoid caffeinated beverages / chocolates etc**